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14,000 babies will die in Gaza in next 48 hours without aid: UN

UAE STRONGLY CONDEMNS ISRAELI AIRSTRIKES ON HOSPITAL IN GAZA

GENEVA

The UN humanitarian chief, Tom Fletcher, said 14,000 babies will die in Gaza in the next 48 hours if aid supplies don't reach them, according to the BBC.

Asked how the UN arrived at that figure, Fletcher said: "We have strong teams on the ground."

He said five aid lorries crossed on Monday, after Israel ended an 11-week blockade, but they haven't reached communities yet. Fletcher said he hoped to get 100 lorries into Gaza by end of the day yesterday — adding that "we need to flood the Gaza Strip with humanitarian aid."

Reacting to an earlier statement from the UK, France, and Canada, which demanded Israel change course, Fletcher called it "robust words" — but said the "real test" is whether the UN can get more aid in.

UAE denounces attack

Earlier, the UAE condemned in the strongest terms the Israeli airstrikes on the Hamad Prosthetics Hospital in the Gaza



Trucks carrying aid wait to enter the Gaza Strip from the Israeli Kerem Shalom crossing yesterday. AFP

Strip, which resulted in the death and injury of a number of innocent people. The UAE denounced the attack as a blatant violation of international humanitarian law, and warned against the ongoing Israeli aggression and military escalation which threaten to cause further loss of life and exacerbate the

humanitarian catastrophe in the Strip.

Meanwhile, The Palestinian Ministry of Health has warned of catastrophic consequences resulting from ongoing Israeli practices targeting hospitals. The ministry said that the Indonesian Hospital has suffered a complete power outage after

Israeli forces struck its electricity generators, forcing the hospital to shut down entirely.

Israeli strikes pounded Gaza overnight and into yesterday, hitting a family home and a school-turned-shelter, and killing at least 85 people, Palestinian health officials said. — Agencies

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UAE's first electric air taxi trial flight this year

ABU DHABI

The trial flights of Archer Aviation's first fully electric vertical takeoff and landing (eVTOL) aircraft 'Midnight' is set to begin before end of this year.

Speaking on the sidelines of the "Make it in the Emirates" forum, Dr Talib Alhinai, general manager of Archer Aviation, said the air-



craft marks a major step in the country's urban air mobility goals, with operations set to begin in Abu Dhabi ahead of full commercial rollout.

Alhinai said initial test flights will take place in unpopulated areas, gradually expanding to urban zones as part of the phased approach to full deployment.

— WAM

UAE banks are set to raise minimum account balance

Banks could push minimum balance from current Dh3,000 to Dh5,000

DUBAI

BY HUDA ATA

Special to Gulf News

Several major banks operating in the UAE plan to increase the minimum required balance for current accounts from Dh3,000 to Dh5,000 starting June 1, according to the UAE Central Bank's regulations on personal loans.

At least one leading bank has already implemented the new minimum balance, and others are expected to follow suit, according to a survey conducted by *Emarat Al Youm*.

The move, which will directly affect account holders across the country, introduces a higher financial bar for maintaining bank accounts without incurring fees. Under the revised policy, customers who fail to meet the new Dh5,000 minimum balance will be subject to a monthly fee of Dh25, unless they qualify for an exemption.

To be exempt from the monthly fee, banks now require customers to either maintain a total account bal-

Under the revised policy, customers who fail to meet the new Dh5,000 minimum balance will be subject to a monthly fee of Dh25, unless they qualify for an exemption.

ance of Dh20,000 or more, transfer a monthly salary of at least Dh15,000, or if their salary falls between Dh5,000 and Dh14,999, hold an active credit card, overdraft facility, or loan with the bank.

For those who transfer a salary of less than Dh5,000, or who do not meet the additional criteria, the monthly fee applies automatically. For account holders who do not fit into any of the above categories, the fees could rise further, with some banks charging Dh100 or Dh105 per month, depending on the type of account.

The current system, in place since 2011, set the minimum balance for personal loan-linked accounts at Dh3,000 to qualify for a waiver of the Dh25 monthly fee.

Huda Ata is an independent writer based in the UAE.

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